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Racial Injustice and Police Violence in the United States

The concept of racism has proven to be a major monstrosity in the United States throughout the years. Recent social movements, however, have rejected the idea of normalizing racism through protests and community empowerment following the deaths of African Americans that succumbed as a result of racial injustice. Some scholars like Derrick Bell and Kimberlé Crenshaw who heavily expanded the critical theory perspective, identify racism as an issue and believe that it can be challenged through the transformation of power dynamics in the aim to increase social equality. For this paper, I aim to use the critical theory lens to assess the systemic racism embedded in law enforcement practices and explore avenues for social change and community empowerment.

The prolific discrimination in the United States is deeply rooted from historic racial oppression during the slavery times where law enforcement was used to maintain working conditions. Blacks have had to endure through violence as they were both physically and mentally abused by their oppressors. The roles were divided into two whereby the 'negroes' were set aside as slaves while the whites were classified as slave patrol to ensure the workers total co-operation and

avoid their escape/ The concept of white supremacy derived from the slavery era where we saw slave patrols transition into the role of the police. Although it was not as clear to see, the white population felt threatened by the blacks following the generational criminalization of the people of color. We can see this as there were reported to be multiple reported threats of innocent blacks that were assumed to be involved in criminal activities. A good example of this was the death of George Floyd who was a victim of police brutality. The public was seen talking to the streets to protest quoting his last words 'I can't breathe'. It was quite poetic to see how ironic it was for the police officer to be kneeling on his neck signifying 'whites being on top of blacks and giving no room for freedom.

Analysis

The evident awareness of racial police brutality has seen a call for change as the United States works to educate its people on the issue. From a critical theory perspective the George Floyd movement accurately displays the realization of the law enforcement and racial backgrounds being interconnected. The main points of critical theory being emancipation, it is clear to see that the policing is a result of a need for controlling and calls for the radical rethinking of justice. The scope is shaped in the aim of thinking about the possibility of law enforcement serving the public via resistance and reforming. This is clear to see the identification of racial inequality as

an obstacle and the black lives matter movement following the death of George Floyd as a response to the issue.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Critical theory incorporates a wide range of approaches all focused on the idea of freeing people from the modern state and brings emphasis on justice and universalism. It mainly focuses on transformative change in societies and global relations. Using this scope for my analysis it is clear to see that the relationship between the law enforcement and racial backgrounds have always been interconnected, however the awareness of the threat was discovered following the death of George Floyd playing the role as an eye opener to the public. There is an evident attempt put in to challenge the set system through the transformation of power dynamics in the aim to increase social equality.

Works Cited

<https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2023/09/systemic-racism-pervades-us-police-and-justice-systems-un-mechanism-racial>

